# Adding The Wheels: DM Strategy 🛞

## Introduction 👋

Your LinkedIn DMs are where the rubber meets the road. This is where you guide prospects from initial interest into booked demos and ultimately, signed clients.

Without mastering the art and science of LinkedIn messaging, your lead gen vehicle goes nowhere.

In this module, we'll explore strategies and frameworks for moving conversations smoothly through the pipeline - from opening line to booked call.

## Overview 👁️

In this video, we'll cover:

- **Crafting opening lines** that spark engagement 💬
- **Qualifying and nurturing leads** through 4-step DM Framework 🤝
- **Transitioning conversations** from DM to demo 🎬
- **DM tactics to schedule** demos/discovery effectively 💰

By the end, you'll have all the tools needed to steer conversations skillfully towards revenue-generating demos.

Let’s get rolling.

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# DM Foundations 📚

## Why Are DMs So Important? 🔑

By this point, you've already done a fair amount of work to get yourself and your LinkedIn profile to the place that it is now. You've turned your profile into a sales "landing page", you've spent time thinking through your content strategy, and have started to put some systems in place to help you reach those goals you've set.

Perhaps - you may have even started creating and publishing content yourself. And, potentially even started getting impressions and engagement on your posts & profile.

This is great.

This is the beginning of the car starting to come together.

But I'm going to let you in on a harsh truth that took me months to figure out:

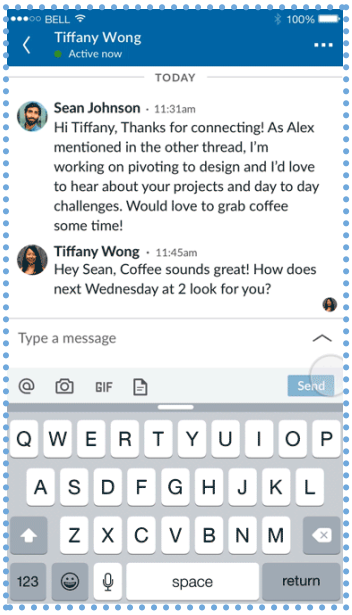
**Without a solid DM strategy, you will <u>never</u> actually get your car moving.**

This is because you will never be able to capture and convert those new eyeballs that you're getting into real conversations, relationships, and eventually sales. All of that "conversion" does not happen within your profile and it doesn't happen within your content (although content does help a ton).

The "conversion" happens in the DMs.

This is where you can have genuine 1:1 conversations with people who have discovered you (content) and decided you're legit (profile).

So, let's talk about DM strategy.

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## Stop. Be a Genuine Human Being. 🛑

Somebody told me this when I was first starting out with DMs, and it stuck with me. I try to pass it on to others that I teach about LinkedIn growth:

**At the beginning of your LinkedIn journey, your goal should be to simply <u>start a conversation.</u>**

Forget sales.

Forget MRR.

Forget conversion rate.

Forget **<u>all</u>** of that.

Just have a normal, human conversation with someone.

This will get your wheels turning (pun intended) on how DMs look and feel in practice.

Before you take any of the “sales” advice below or anywhere else for that matter, you should simply get familiar with messaging complete strangers on the internet, and having a genuine human conversation with them.

I promise that if you can do this (i.e. be a real, caring, genuine human being) first, and resist the urge to get people to book a call ASAP, you will get much farther along on LinkedIn - and probably in life.

Like all things in this module, I wish somebody would have told me this when I was just getting started.

Remember, there is actually a real human just like you on the other side of those messages. They, too, have wants, desires, fears, insecurities, frustrations, and 743 other feelings they are dealing with on a daily basis.

With that mindset piece taken care of, let’s talk about opening lines & frameworks.

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## The Art of Opening Lines 💬

Your opening line is the first impression you make on prospects in your DMs. A strong opener sparks interest and kicks off a productive dialogue.

Too often, DMs open by jumping right into a sales pitch. This pushy approach rarely works.

Instead, craft personalized opening lines tailored to prospects' needs. The goal is eventually beginning to uncover pain points you can alleviate.

Here are 5 proven opening line frameworks:

1. 🤔 **Intriguing Question:** E.g. "What's your biggest challenge right now with [SOMETHING ABOUT THEIR BUSINESS]?"

2. 📈 **Reference Their Content:** E.g. "Loved your post on AI content creation tools. Have you tried [TOOL] before?"

3. 🏆 **Compliment + Question:** E.g. "Your agency looks like it's dominating the cold email [NICHE] space right now. What's been the biggest unlock for you guys this year?"

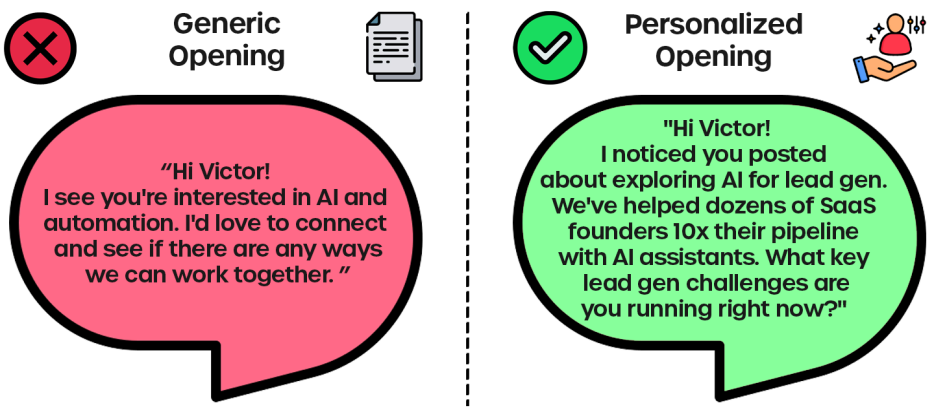
4. 💡 **Offer Unique Perspective:** E.g. "I saw you commented on [PERSON]'s post on AI in marketing, loved your take! Have you thought about [UNIQUE PERSPECTIVE] instead?"

5. 🎁 **Provide Value Upfront:** E.g. "I saw your latest post re: figuring out AI vendors. I just created a checklist for vetting AI developers [RESOURCE]. Happy to send it over if helpful?"

The key is personalization and genuine curiosity. Prospects can sense generic outreach a mile away. Do your research and craft opening lines catered specifically to them.

This grabs attention immediately and gets conversations headed in the right direction.

Let's look at some examples:




See the difference? Do your homework and personalize DMs. This builds rapport fast and keeps dialogue productive. Now let's look at qualifying leads and uncovering needs...

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## Qualifying Leads Through Conversation 🤝

Beyond strong openers, you need to skillfully qualify leads by identifying pain and building rapport.

This means navigating conversations smoothly toward the next steps without being pushy salespeople.

### The 4-Step DM Framework 🪜

Here's a simple 4-step framework for productive DMs:

1. **Opening:** Open with personalized, value-driven question

   *Ex: "What's your biggest challenge right now with [SOMETHING ABOUT THEIR BUSINESS]?"*

2. **Clarify:** Ask clarifying questions to understand needs. Your goal here is to figure out if they even have a problem that you can help them solve, or not.

   *Ex: "What kind of lead gen tactics are you guys running right now? What's not working?"*

3. **Be Valuable:** Provide unique perspectives and helpful resources

   *Ex: I hear you, it's difficult nowadays. Have you tried automating your lead capture? You can create a simple lead capture form in Tally, and automatically send leads to your CRM using Make.com. I can send you a quick Loom video if it's helpful.*

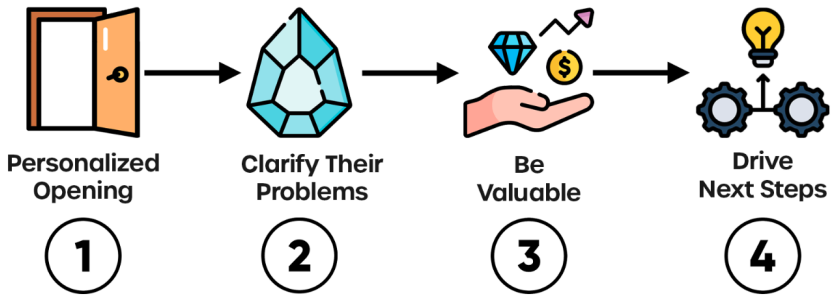
4. **Drive Next Steps:** Suggest next steps if appropriate

   *Ex: I'd love to show you more about how this works, but it's hard to do via text. Are you free on Monday? 3 or 4pm EST? I'll walk you through in detail.*

Essentially, you guide prospects from showing initial interest → unpacking their goals → building trust → booking demos.

This is the process.

This gradual progression turns cold conversations into qualified, demo-ready leads, who no longer THINK but KNOW that you can help them.

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## Example Framework Conversation 🖼️

Let's break this down further using real DM examples:

**1. Opening Line**

*You: "Hi [Name], your latest post on how you guys helped your restaurant client get more customers with AI was genius, love the design-first approach. What kinds of problems do you find your clients have most often?"*

**2. Clarifying Questions**

*Them: "Mainly generating enough awareness and leads. Most businesses we speak with don't really understand AI yet."*

*You: "Got it. What have you guys tried so far for marketing and lead gen? I'm happy to share what has worked for us in the past."*

**3. Provide Value**

*Them: "Mainly just posting general content about AI and automation...but haven't seen much traction yet."*

*You: "Makes total sense. We took a very similar approach initially. I'm happy to share what we changed that helped us 10x our leads. I also have a checklist for creating AI content that converts. Feel free to take a look..."*

**4. Suggest Next Steps**

*Them: "Wow that would be extremely helpful, thanks! Would love any advice you have..."*

*You: "For sure! Why don't we jump on a quick call next Tuesday to discuss further? I can share some strategies that we built that could help. Do you have time on Tuesday at 2pm EST? Here's my calendar if it's easier: [CALENDAR LINK]."*

This balanced cadence builds rapport while advancing the conversation. You uncover needs, provide unique value, and guide towards a demo.

Now, this is a general framework you can use.

But, not all DM conversations are exactly the same.

Let's examine DM strategies for various scenarios...

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# DM Strategies for Different Scenarios 📝

Not all messaging opportunities are created equal. DM strategy varies depending on context and prospect awareness.

Let's explore approaches for 3 common scenarios:

- **A) Cold Outreach**
- **B) Warm Leads from Content**
- **C) Inbound Inquiries**

Let’s talk about each one by one.

## Scenario A: Cold Outreach 🥶

Cold outreach means messaging prospects with no prior connection or engagement.

This channel can absolutely generate quality leads but requires extra finesse given the intrusive nature. Remember, you’re ‘interrupting’ their flow when you come in cold.

Make sure you make it worth their while.

### Cold DM Outreach Best Practices ✅

Here are some cold DM best practices to follow on LinkedIn:

- **Personalize messages**
- **Provide enormous value upfront**
- **Ask smart questions**
- **Suggest casual first conversation**

The key here is building rapport and trust from scratch. Overcome coldness by leading with warmth.

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## Cold DM Outreach Example 📕

Here's an example cold outreach flow:

*You: "Hi [Name]! Your agency's mission resonates a lot with what we aim to do at [Your Agency]. I loved your post on AI content creation. Have you explored leveraging AI writing assistants like Claude or Copy.ai? I've just made a report comparing the top ones that you're welcome to check out."*

*Them: "Hi! Not yet but very interested to learn more. Appreciate you reaching out and offering that report."*

*You: "For sure! So what drew you to exploring AI content tools in the first place? Also curious if you're running into any obstacles with ideation and drafting engaging posts?"*

*Them: "Mainly just struggling to find enough time to create content consistently. An AI assistant could help alleviate that. How are you using these tools if you don't mind me asking?"*

*You: "Totally understandable. We struggled a ton with consistency initially too. We use Claude every week for ideation to map out 2 months worth of content in one session. Happy to show you our process! Maybe we could jump on a 20 minute call sometime next week?"*

Notice the value exchange here. Offer enormous value upfront via resources and recommendations. Then get smart through probing questions.

Think of it this way:

**Earn the right to suggest a casual exploratory call.**

This cold messaging framework warmly moves the conversation forward.

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## Scenario B: Warm Leads From Content 🥵

Warm leads stem from prospects engaging with your content already. They have context on you but need nurturing.

In other words, they THINK you might be able to help them… but they're not 100% sure yet.

Messaging strategy here is less intrusive since they've already raised their hand.

### Warm DM Outreach Best Practices ✅

Best practices include:

- **Thank them for engaging**
- **Ask smart questions about their goals**
- **Offer relevant resources to build authority**
- **Suggest next step based on interest level**

You have a warmer start here having put yourself on prospects' radars. Double down by uncovering needs and building mindshare.

### Warm DM Outreach Example 📕

Here is an example flow:

*You: "Hi [Name]! Appreciate you watching my video on lead gen with AI. Have you used anything like an AI assistant to automate parts of your sales process before?"*

*Them: "Thanks for posting such helpful content! We haven't tried any automation yet but very intrigued by the potential."*

*You: "Of course, glad you found it helpful. We were skeptical too originally but saw great results after testing some solutions. I'm happy to demo and walk you through specifics if helpful?"*

*Them: "That would be amazing actually. We need something to help handle our growing lead volume. What's the best way to see some of your automations in action?"*

*You: "Why don't we grab 30 minutes on Calendly sometime this or next week? I can show you our assistants and also share some proven frameworks we use for finding top automation opportunities. Here's a link to book a time: [CALENDAR LINK]."*

This warmer messaging cadence continues building rapport with value exchange before smoothly transitioning to a demo.

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## Scenario C: Inbound Inquiries 📥

Inbound messages represent the warmest leads stemming straight from your content and profile.

They have actively raised their hand by reaching out first.

This is the golden snitch.

Strategy here is simply catching what has come your way, and guiding them towards demos.

### Inbound Inquiries Best Practices ✅

Here are the best practices:

- **Thank them for reaching out**
- **Directly answer questions**
- **Provide relevant resources**
- **Suggest booking a call**

With interested prospects coming to you, keep momentum going towards a demo.

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## Inbound Inquiries Example 📕

Here's an example:

*Them: "Hey, love the AI assistants you've built for lead gen and outreach! Would be very interested in learning more about potentially implementing something similar for our agency. Are you open to exploring?"*

*You: "Hi [Name]! Really appreciate you reaching out. So glad to hear our solutions resonate with you. Absolutely have availability coming up to walk you through. Did you have any particular questions coming in? Or areas you were most curious about?"*

*Them: "Mainly just understanding what's possible and how to get started. Also would love any ballpark estimates on pricing and timelines."*

*You: "Got it. I'm happy to give you a full overview and potential roadmap on a call. As far as pricing, our solutions usually pay for themselves in added revenue within 2-3 months. And we can deploy MVPs within 3 weeks typically. Want to grab 30 mins on Calendly to discuss further?"*

Notice here you simply guide interested prospects further down the funnel.

Thank them for engagement, answer questions, and direct them right into a demo.

Now let's shift gears to actually selling and delivering those demos...

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# Transitioning from DMs to Demos 🎬

Alright, by this point you've done a lot of the hard work already! Now, we just need to finalize and get people to agree to a discovery call with us.

We've covered quite a few example scenarios already, but I wanted to spend some dedicated time on the actual "call booking" part of the DM strategy, as it's very important.

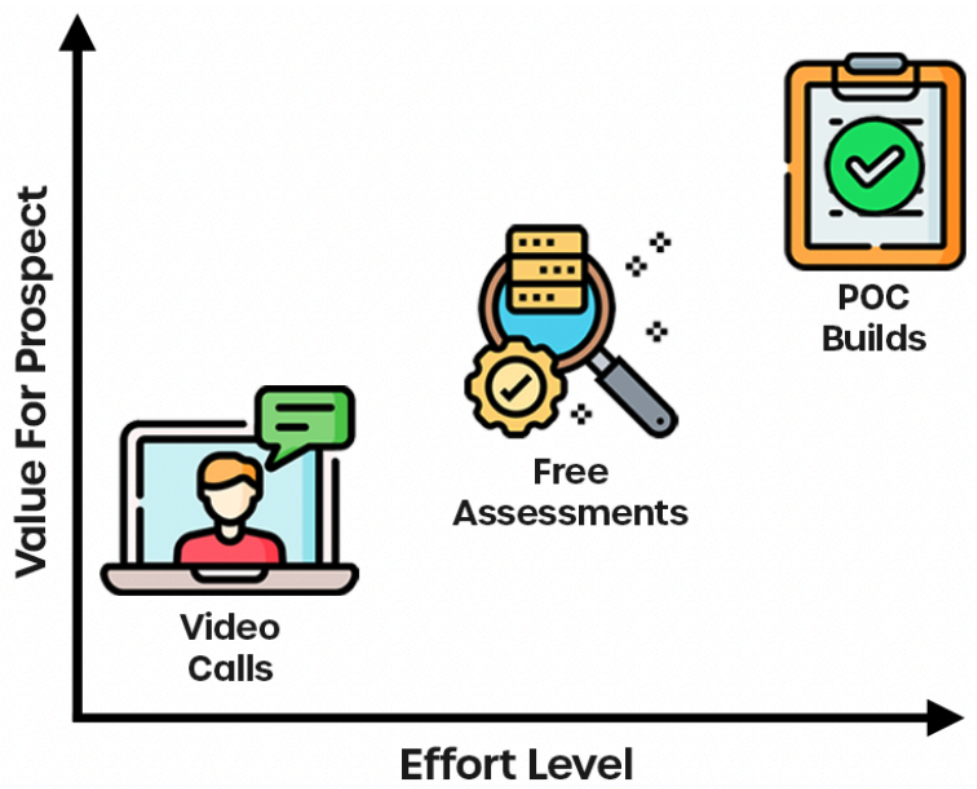
So let's get started.

## 3 Proven Tactics to Book More Discovery Calls ⚙️

At some point within your conversations, you need to guide prospects into demos.

This is where they experience your capabilities firsthand and get sold on partnerships.

Here are 3 proven tactics for advancing DMs into demos:

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## 1. Simple Transition to Video Calls 📹

This is the simplest, easiest, and most frictionless way to get a prospect to agree to your next steps. People generally have a good idea of what comes next with this tactic.

You should lean on this tactic when you have people who are familiar with you, your content, and your ability to help them.

*Ex: "Want to jump on a quick video chat next Tuesday? Easiest way for me to showcase capabilities and walk through some solutions."*

## 2. Offer Free Assessments 🆓

For those who are interested but still skeptical about giving up 30 minutes of their time for you, you can experiment with this tactic.

Try offering people a free “assessment” or “audit” to make sure that they know that regardless of what happens moving forward, they will at least walk away with something beneficial - for free.

*Ex: "We offer 30 minute AI assessments to map out automation opportunities tailored to your business goals. Happy to get one scheduled!"*

## 3. Propose Proof-of-Concept Builds 🦾

There is a huge difference between building POCs to build credibility (and lightly determine feasibility) and doing free work.

Building POCs is one of the most effective ways to generate next step calls, and overall new business in general.

But, of course, this is the highest lift tactic, so you should use it sparingly, and only when you truly believe the opportunity is there for you on the other side of the fence.

**PRO TIP:** Once you’ve built a few proof of concepts (POCs, aka prototypes), you can reuse them for new prospects with minimal incremental work.

*Ex: "We could build a simple AI prototype for lead qualification so you can test capabilities risk-free. Does a POC seem worthwhile?"*

Essentially, you are taking the value exchange to the next level: from conversational → to tactical scoping → to capability showcasing.

This logical progression is non-salesy while advancing the ball.

Once they experience your solutions, closing deals becomes much easier.

Now let's examine how to actually schedule and run those critical demos...

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# Wrapping Up 🏁

That concludes our deep dive into elevating LinkedIn conversations into revenue.

We covered a lot of ground on strategically guiding prospects from opening lines toward closed deals.

Let's recap the key lessons:

- **Opening Lines:** Personalized opening lines spark engagement 💬
- **Clarify & Qualify:** Smart questioning qualifies leads 💥
- **Different Scenarios:** Use different DM approaches based on cold, warm, or inbound 🥵
- **DM Tactics:** Tactical demos progress deals 🤝

With these messaging strategies and frameworks mastered, you can smoothly steer any conversation from curious prospect to satisfied customer.

Next we'll explore tactics for scaling all of your LinkedIn efforts through smart outreach and engagement.

Catch you in the next one.

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